

# OnePlus 12R

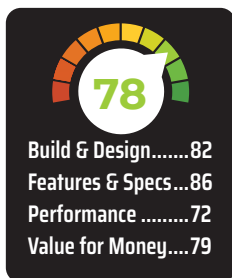
## A solid incremental upgrade

**T**he OnePlus 12R was unveiled to the world alongside its flagship sibling – the OnePlus 12. The OnePlus ‘R’ series of smartphones has always been ridiculously popular due to the value proposition it offers when compared to its flagship counterpart. While the sentiment around OnePlus prices and software is polarising (with some feeling the glory days of OnePlus’ ‘flagship killer’ status are over), 2023 proved to be a great year for the company – a return to form in a way with great launches like the OnePlus 11, OnePlus 11R, and OnePlus Open. The company is also putting things into high gear in 2024 and has already kicked off the year with the highly-anticipated OnePlus 12 and the OnePlus 12R (oh, and the OnePlus Buds 3). The OnePlus 12R has some worthy upgrades over its successor such as a new aluminium frame, an improved display, and a larger battery, but it certainly doesn’t appear to be a generational leap, on paper. Nevertheless, let’s dive into the detailed review of the OnePlus 12R to determine if it’s a good option to buy under ₹45,000 in 2024.

### BUILD AND DESIGN

Part of the reason why the OnePlus 12R doesn’t come across straight away as a massive upgrade over the 11R is because they look nearly identical. Yes, there are a couple of structural changes such as a premium new aluminium frame that replaces the plastic on the 11R and IP65 dust and water resistance. However, the facade is still nearly the same.

The OnePlus 12R is available in two colourways – Cool Blue and Iron Gray. While the Iron Gray variant’s rear panel is largely resistant to fingerprints and



smudges due to a matte texture, the Cool Blue review unit I got attracted hordes of fingerprint marks that made the back look unattractive within seconds of laying hands on it. This is why I don’t appreciate when the variants are not consistent across the board because some buyers may unknowingly get the worse end of the deal. Nevertheless, the colour-matched case inside should solve this issue for most people (unless you enjoy rocking your phone without a case).

Everything from the placement of the OnePlus logo to the camera module to the iconic OnePlus slider stays the same. The only difference is that the flash now sits outside the circular camera module. The phone feels good to hold in hand, thanks to the curved contours of its body, but my Cool Blue review unit was very slippery to hold. The buttons are nice and tactile, but the optical fingerprint reader disappointed me because it is quite slow.

Overall, the OnePlus 12R is well-built – it even has an IP65 rating for extra

protection against the elements. However, the fingerprint magnet rear panel holds back the phone from scoring higher in this segment.

### DISPLAY

OnePlus has improved the display considerably on the new 12R. For starters, this is an LTPO 4.0 AMOLED panel that can dynamically switch the refresh rate all the way from 1 Hz to 120 Hz. It worked flawlessly when I tested it out. In fact, if you scroll slowly, it doesn’t bump the refresh rate all the way up, which can improve battery efficiency. The 6.78-inch display supports HDR10+ and Dolby Vision, and it is one of the best displays I’ve reviewed at this price point. HDR works flawlessly on apps such as YouTube and Netflix. Colours look vivid, content looks sharp, and the viewing angles are great. The phone has a 1.5 K resolution and 450 PPI, making things look super crisp.

Furthermore, the brightness has taken a huge leap. This year around, the OnePlus 12R hits 1,600 nits of peak rated brightness in High Brightness Mode and a whopping 4,500 nits of peak brightness in Auto Mode. Of course, these numbers are tested in a controlled lab environment and the maximum reading I got in my testing under sunlight was around 2,200 nits, which is still staggeringly bright.

As for the display’s aesthetics, it is a curved AMOLED display with narrow and nearly even bezels all the way around. There’s a punch-hole cutout for the front camera which doesn’t get in the way of an immersive viewing experience.

### PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus 12R is powered by an upgraded Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 chipset – a flagship offering until last year, that’s now available under ₹40,000 on the 12R. You get 8 or 16 GB of the latest LPDDR5X RAM and 128 or 256 GB of internal storage. There’s no expandable memory, which is a disappointment since even 256 GB could be inadequate for some users’ needs in 2024. Another